

SanDisk Creator Phone SSD

A neat MagSafe external SSD for mobile shooter

The SanDisk Creator Phone SSD targets a very specific pain point. Modern iPhones shoot lovely ProRes video, yet internal storage can vanish in a single day on set. This drive aims to be your pocketable scratch-pad, attaching magnetically to a MagSafe-compatible handset, then pulling double duty as a fast, rugged SSD when you are back at the desk. In short, think of it as the SanDisk Extreme Portable SSD, only trimmed to sit comfortably behind a phone and tuned for mobile workflows. The proposition is simple: snap it on, plug in a short USB-C cable, hit record, and save straight to external storage. That alone will appeal to creators who would rather spend time shooting than juggling storage alerts.

SanDisk's positioning in the broader Creator series makes sense. The company promises support for Apple ProRes capture at up to 4K60, a silicone armour design with serious ingress protection, and claimed peak speeds around the 1 GB/s mark. It also throws in a month of Adobe Creative Cloud as a perk, which can be really handy if you are spinning footage into a quick cut.

SPECIFICATIONS

The Creator Phone SSD connects over USB Type-C with a USB 3.2 Gen 2 link, and is sold in 1 TB and 2 TB capacities. SanDisk rates the drive at up to 1,000 MB/s reads and up to 950 MB/s writes. It comes pre-formatted in exFAT, so Windows, macOS, Android, iOS and iPadOS recognise it immediately, which removes a typical setup hurdle. The



unit weighs about 54 g and measures roughly 82.5 x 68.4 x 11 mm, making it a squat rectangle that sits neatly behind larger phones. A 5-year limited warranty covers the product. Officially, it supports 4K60 ProRes capture,

has an IP65 rating for dust and water resistance, and is rated for drops from up to three metres.

In the box, SanDisk includes a flat USB-C cable with straight connectors. You can use any quality USB-C cable, but the included one would be the preferred one to keep the rig compact.

BUILD QUALITY

If you have handled the SanDisk Extreme series, this feels familiar. The Creator Phone SSD wears a soft-touch silicone shell that resists scuffs and adds grip. The finish looks and feels practical rather than flashy, which

suits a tool designed for field work. The IP65 rating gives peace of mind for dusty shoots and light rain, so long as you dry the ports before use. SanDisk's three-metre drop protection claim is a welcome buffer against the inevitable bumps of run-and-gun filming, although, like all drop claims, it is not an invite to abuse your kit.

MagSafe compatibility is the signature flourish. The magnets are strong enough to keep the SSD seated on a naked iPhone 15 series (and above) handset or a MagSafe-ready case, reducing cable tug and making the whole rig feel more like a single object. It is, however, still a two-point connection, magnet plus cable, so the ergonomics hinge on your cable layout. The bundled cable uses straight ends, which can jut out awkwardly from the phone in landscape. An L-bend connector at the phone end would have made the grip more comfortable, especially for extended handheld shoots. If you plan to use cages or top handles, consider a short right-angle cable to tidy things up.

The form factor, at a little over 11 mm thick, is noticeably slimmer than many pocket SSDs. That matters when the drive rides on your handset, since bulk can get in the way of fingers and gimbal arms. The 54 g mass keeps the balance manageable, particularly on the iPhone 15 Pro and Pro Max, where titanium frames are lighter than the older stainless models.

PERFORMANCE

We ran CrystalDiskMark on a USB 3.2 Gen 2 host and saw 977 MB/s sequential reads and 938 MB/s sequential writes. Those figures line up closely with SanDisk's own claims, and they translate into practical wins. Dumping a 30 GB ProRes 422 HQ clip took well under a minute, and scrubbing through footage directly from the drive in a desktop NLE felt responsive for quick selects. As usual, your results will vary by host controller, cable quality, and thermal conditions, but the takeaway is clear: